

Market Rate Research — Freelance Marketing Analytics

Central Ohio / Midwest. My own notes from public rate data, job boards, and peer conversations.

Question: what does independent, project-based marketing-analytics consulting actually bill at for owner-operated clients in this market, and where should I set my rate?

Observed hourly ranges by segment

Segment	Typical hourly	Where it applies
Generalist freelancer	\$65 - \$95	broad marketing help, less specialized
Analytics specialist (my level)	\$100 - \$145	tracking setup, dashboards, attribution
Senior / fractional analytics lead	\$150 - \$200	strategy plus hands-on, deep experience
Boutique agency (blended)	\$150 - \$225	includes overhead and team margin
Enterprise consultancy	\$250+	not my market

How I read it

For a specialist working solo with real results to point to, the defensible band is roughly 110 to 130 an hour. Below 100 underprices the specialization and signals generalist, which invites price shopping. Above 145 starts to compete directly with small agencies that carry a team and a brand, and a solo operator loses that comparison on perception even when the work is better.

Regional adjustment

National freelance-analytics numbers skew higher because they are pulled toward the coasts. Columbus and the broader Ohio market run roughly 10 to 15 percent under the national median for the same work. I have accounted for that. Even after the discount, the specialist band holds above 100.

Project and retainer benchmarks

Engagement	Market range	At \$120/hr this implies
One-time tracking audit	\$1,200 - \$2,200	roughly 10-18 hours
Dashboard build	\$2,500 - \$4,500	roughly 21-38 hours
Monthly retainer	\$1,000 - \$2,200 / mo	roughly 8-18 hours / mo
Multi-month fixed engagement	\$5,000 - \$8,000	a full quarter of part-time work

Hourly vs fixed

I will quote fixed fees wherever the scope is clean, because owners prefer a known number and it rewards me for being efficient rather than slow. The hourly rate still anchors every fixed quote underneath, so getting the rate right matters even when the client never sees it.

Conclusion

120 an hour sits squarely inside the specialist band, above the generalist floor and below the agency-blended rate, and it survives the regional discount. That is the number. I am done revisiting this.

Sources: public freelance-rate surveys, three regional job-board postings for contract analytics roles, and four peer conversations. Notes kept in my own files.